Forge Radar #2

Six updates for people building with AI agents
16-23 October 2026

Primary sources only

Skills over MCP is official

SEP-2640 is now an official MCP extension. Bloomberg describes how it helped standardize agent skills at scale.

Why it matters: a standard way to serve skills over MCP.

Databricks Agent Memory (Beta)

On Databricks' internal benchmarks, memory tripled the agent pass rate while using 31% fewer tokens.

Why it matters: vendor numbers, so test on your own tasks.

Agents that pay per use

Mastercard opened Early Access to Agent Pay for Machines, built on the x402 protocol. An agent gets a task and a budget, then pays services with signed vouchers, with no API key per provider.

Why it matters: payments inside agent workflows, within set limits.

Breaking: Agent Framework 1.23.0

Microsoft Agent Framework for Python moves MCP to the 2.x foundation, and AG-UI endpoints now need an explicit auth scope.

Why it matters: read the release notes before you upgrade.

Security fix in Pydantic AI

High-severity advisory GHSA-4whf-38hw-pxxh in web_fetch. Fixed in v2.59.0 and v1.107.9.

Why it matters: update now if your agents fetch URLs.

TURTLE: self-tuning benchmarks

Proposer, solver and feedback agents evolve tool-use tasks. On AppWorld the share of hard tasks rose by 165%.

Why it matters: one way to keep evals from going stale.

arXiv 2610.27307, 19 Oct

Sources

Bloomberg: Skills over MCP (21 Oct)
Databricks: Introducing Agent Memory (20 Oct)
Mastercard: Agent Pay for Machines (20 Oct)
github.com/microsoft/agent-framework python-1.23.0
github.com/pydantic/pydantic-ai v2.59.0
arxiv.org/abs/2610.27307

Full links in the post comments and on X @OpenDataForge.

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